PRODUCT DEMO · HIGHER EDUCATION

Student Self-Enrolment on the Student Portal

Students choose and manage their own subjects — online, in minutes, within the guardrails their institution sets. No forms, no phone queues, no manual data entry for staff.

Built by the **Dynamite Squad** · ReadyTech
Walkthrough by **Sreeram Goalla** · Product, Business Analysis & QA

Introduction

Traditionally, every HE subject enrolment is keyed in by admissions or student-services staff. Self-enrolment moves that routine work to the student — while the system quietly enforces every institutional rule in the background.

🕐

Less admin effort

Routine subject enrolments no longer pass through staff hands — freeing teams for the exceptions that genuinely need them.

🎓

Student autonomy

Students pick their electives and shape their study plan themselves, from any device, whenever the enrolment window is open.

🛡️

Rules always enforced

Requisites, program structure and enrolment windows are checked live. Unlike admin-led enrolment, students can never override them.

⚡

Real-time feedback

Study load, requisite warnings and enrolment deadlines are visible while the student decides — not discovered after the fact.

My role

I tested this feature and then produced this walkthrough from a test environment, to show clients and internal teams how student self-enrolment works and what an institution needs to switch it on.

PRODUCT MANAGER

Told the self-enrolment story to clients

- Built the demo narrative: value first, then institution setup, then the student journey from login to adjusting subjects.
- Framed the benefits by audience: less admin effort for staff, autonomy for students, and rules that are always enforced.
- Made the rollout prerequisites clear for institutions: the feature switch, the enrolment pattern and the enrolment window.
- Showcased the mobile experience as a selling point for students enrolling from any device.

What I produced: Client demo · Value proposition · Rollout prerequisites

BUSINESS ANALYST

Made the setup and the rules easy to follow

- Documented setup from the institution's side: the Features page, the enrolment pattern and academic-period dates.
- Explained the guardrails in plain language: requisites, program structure, study load and enrolment windows.
- Wrote the self-enrolment checklist used to configure test and demo environments.

What I produced: Setup checklist · Business rules · Process walkthrough

QUALITY & TESTING

Verified every screen before showing it

- Ran the full student journey on a test environment and captured each step as evidence, in 25 screenshots.
- Tested save and resume, requisite alerts, the review step and adding or dropping subjects after enrolment.
- Tested the mobile layout of the enrolment flow.
- Used test data only, so the walkthrough can be shared safely.

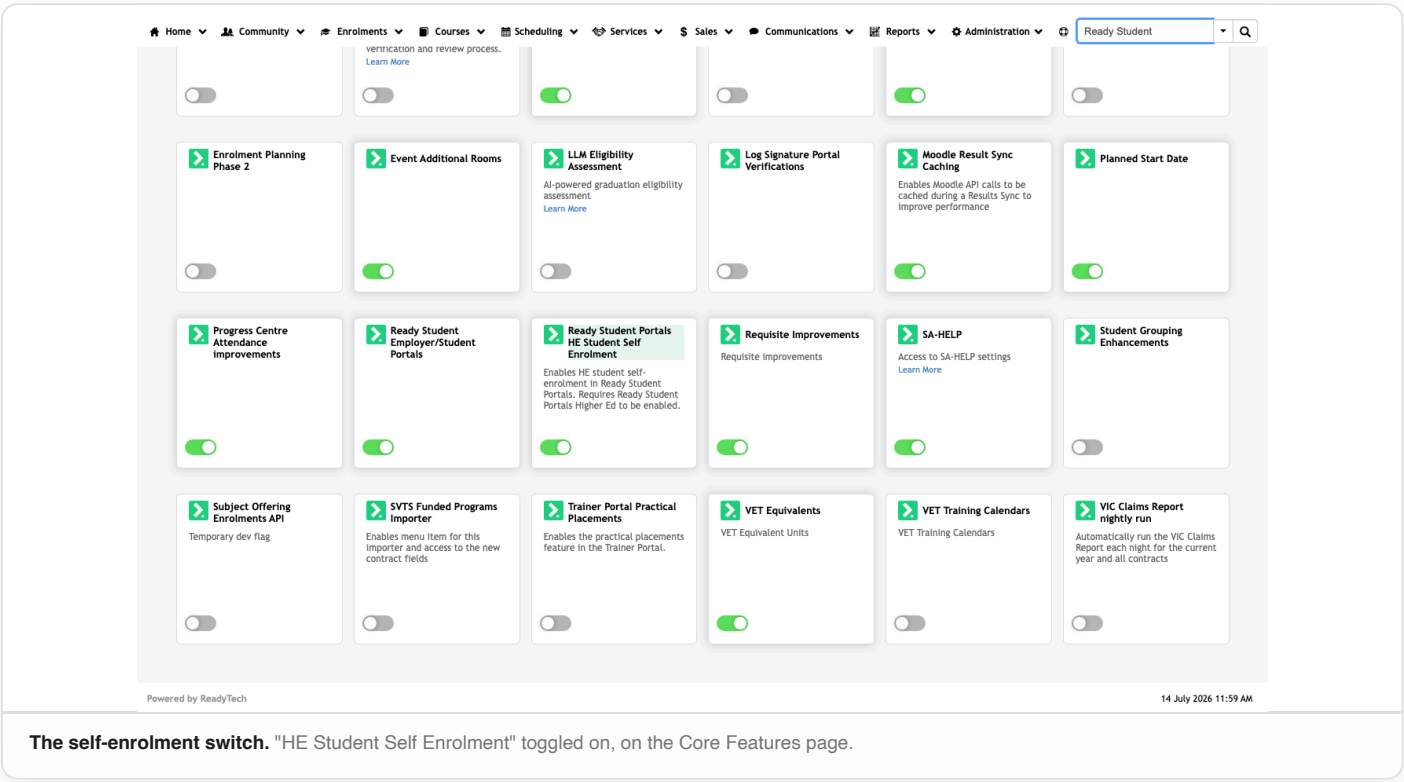
What I produced: Test evidence · Screenshot pack · Regression scenarios

1 Setup — before students can enrol

Everything the student experiences is controlled by the institution on **the student management system (SMS)**. Three switches matter: turning the capability on, choosing the enrolment pattern, and opening the enrolment window.

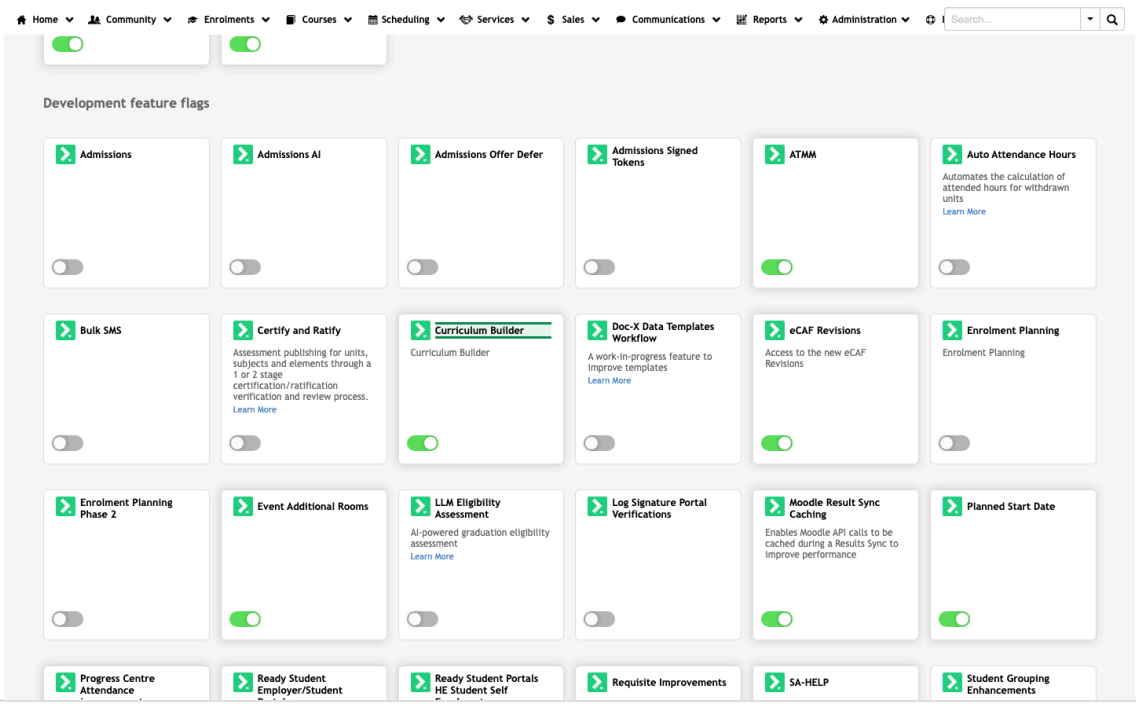
a. Turn the capability on — feature flags

Self-enrolment is enabled per provider from the Core *Features* page (`Help → Features`). The switch is **"HE Student Self Enrolment"** — it requires *Student Portal Higher Ed* (and the base portal flags) to already be on. The Student Portal picks the change up automatically; nothing to deploy.



The self-enrolment switch. "HE Student Self Enrolment" toggled on, on the Core Features page.

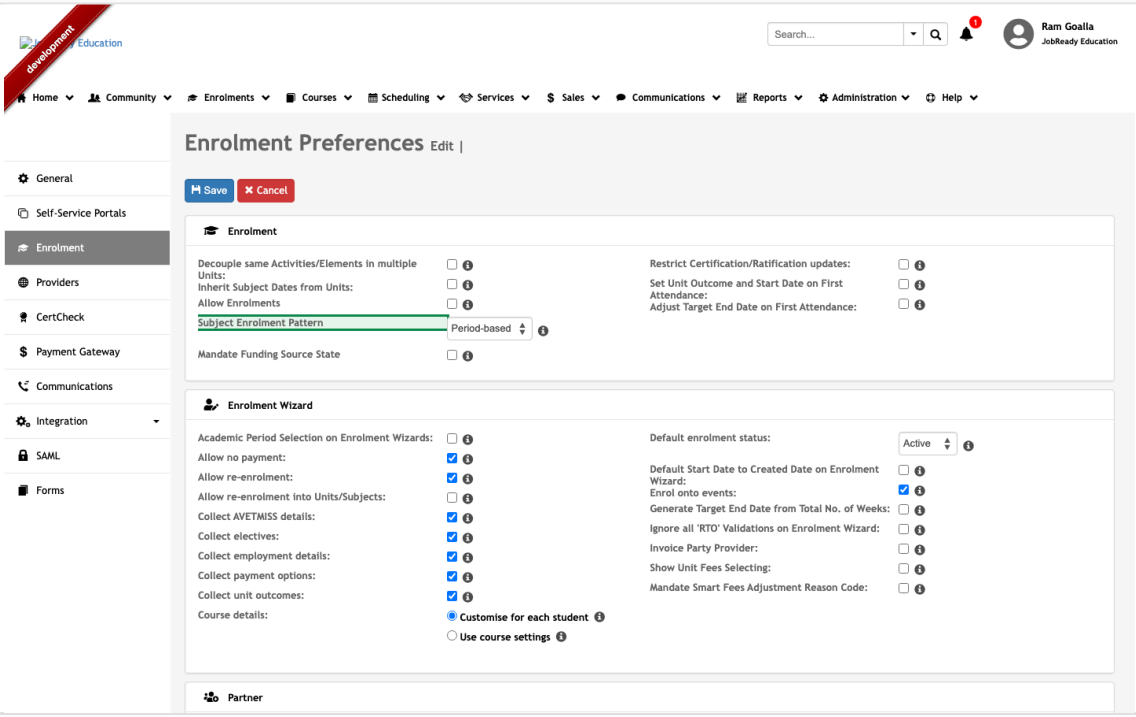
The rules engine behind the wizard is **Curriculum Builder** — it must also be enabled, under *Development feature flags* on the same page. This one is managed by superuser (level 0) accounts only, and is what powers requisite and program-structure validation during enrolment.



The curriculum engine. The "Curriculum Builder" flag (Development feature flags, superuser-only) — the same engine that validates admin-led enrolment.

b. Choose the enrolment pattern

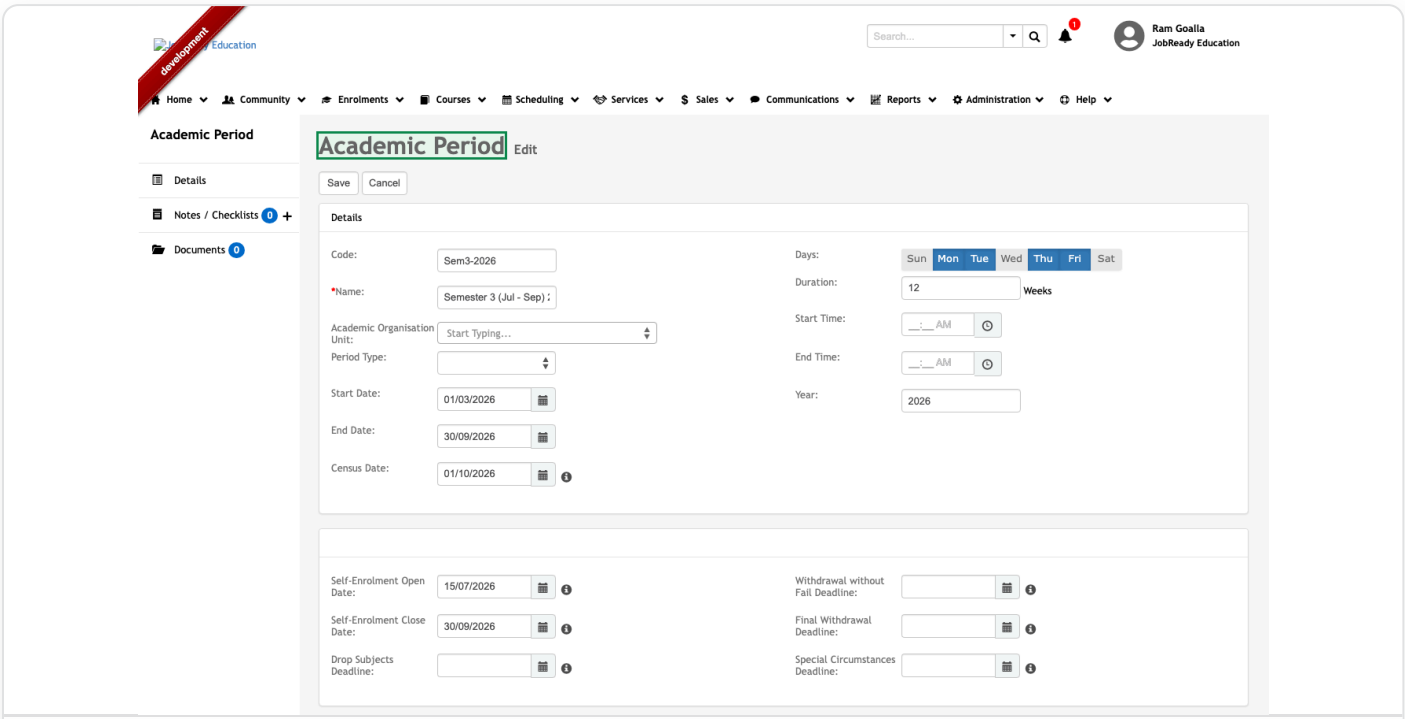
The **Subject Enrolment Pattern** (Administration → Preferences → Enrolment) decides which wizard students get: **Yearly** — one wizard covering every study period in the calendar year, or **Period-based** — one wizard per semester. It's a system-wide default that can be overridden per course, so different programs can run different intake models side by side.



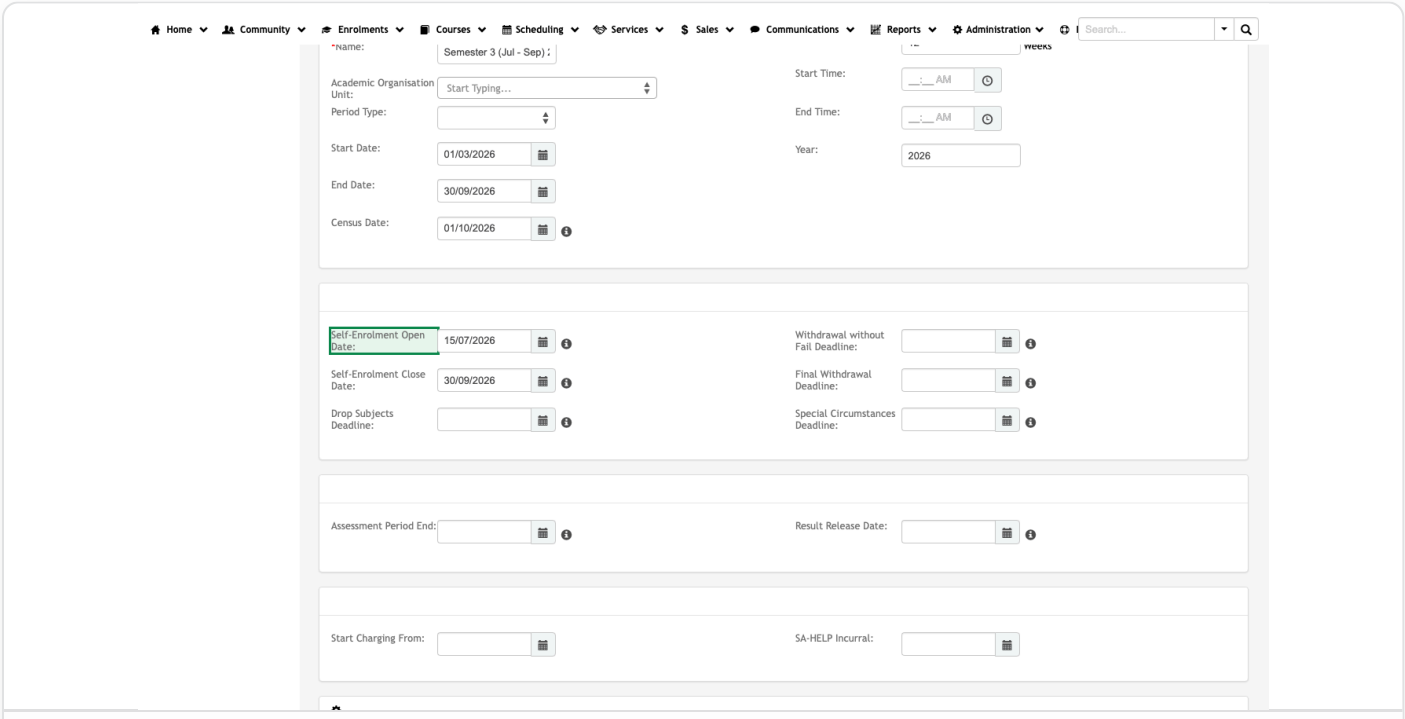
Enrolment Preferences. The "Subject Enrolment Pattern" dropdown — this environment runs *Period-based*, which is why the demo shows a per-semester flow.

c. Open the enrolment window

Each academic period carries its own **Self-Enrolment Open and Close dates**, plus a **Drop Subjects Deadline** — all set on the Academic Period record. These dates gate everything: before the open date or after the close date, the wizard simply isn't reachable, and the "enrolment open" banner never appears.



Where it's configured — the Academic Period edit page. Each study period (here *Semester 3 (Jul – Sep) 2026*, code Sem3-2026) is a record in the SMS with its own details, dates and census date. The self-enrolment fields live on this same page, just below the period details.

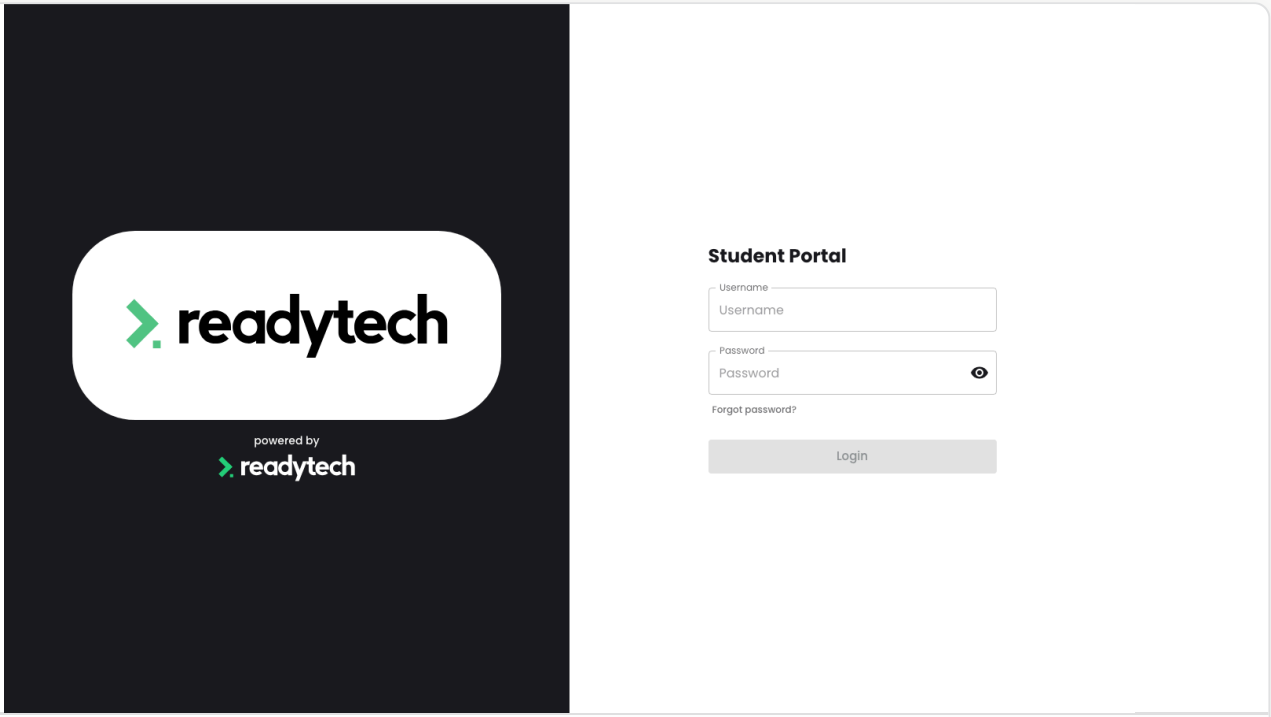


The window, per period. Self-Enrolment Open (15/07/2026) and Close (30/09/2026) dates on the same Academic Period edit page — with the drop deadline and withdrawal deadlines alongside.

> **The setup story in one line:** flip the flag, pick the pattern, set the dates — The SMS stays the single source of truth for who can enrol, in what, and when.

2 Signing in — the Student Portal login

Students access the portal through a clean, branded login page. The institution's logo appears on the left — customisable per provider — with a simple username and password form on the right. A "Forgot password?" link is available for self-service recovery.



The Student Portal login. A split-screen layout — the institution's branding on the left, the login form on the right. Username and password with a "Forgot password?" recovery link. The login page adapts per tenant, showing each provider's own logo.

🏢

Multi-tenant

Each institution gets their own branded login page with their logo — powered by the same platform, isolated per provider.

🔑

Self-service recovery

"Forgot password?" triggers a password reset flow — no need to call the institution's help desk.

🔐

MFA supported

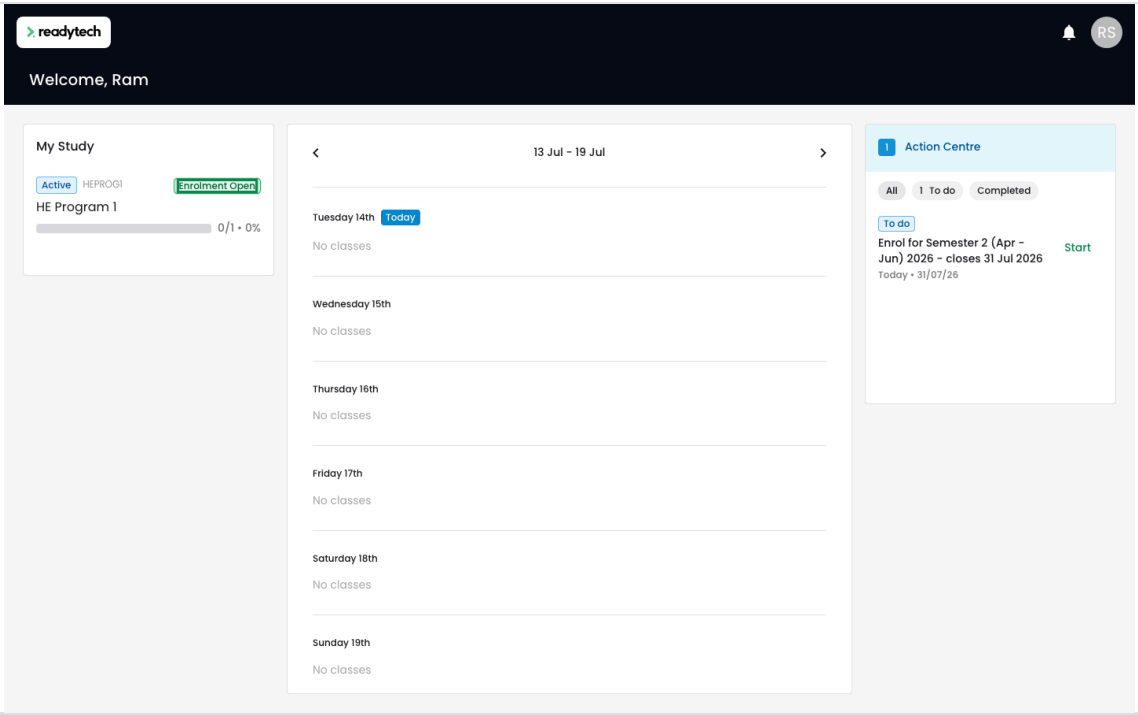
Multi-factor authentication can be enabled for an extra layer of security, with trusted-device support so students aren't prompted on every login.

👤 **Student credentials are managed in the SMS** — when staff create or import a student record, a portal login is provisioned automatically. The student receives their credentials (typically via email) and can sign in immediately.

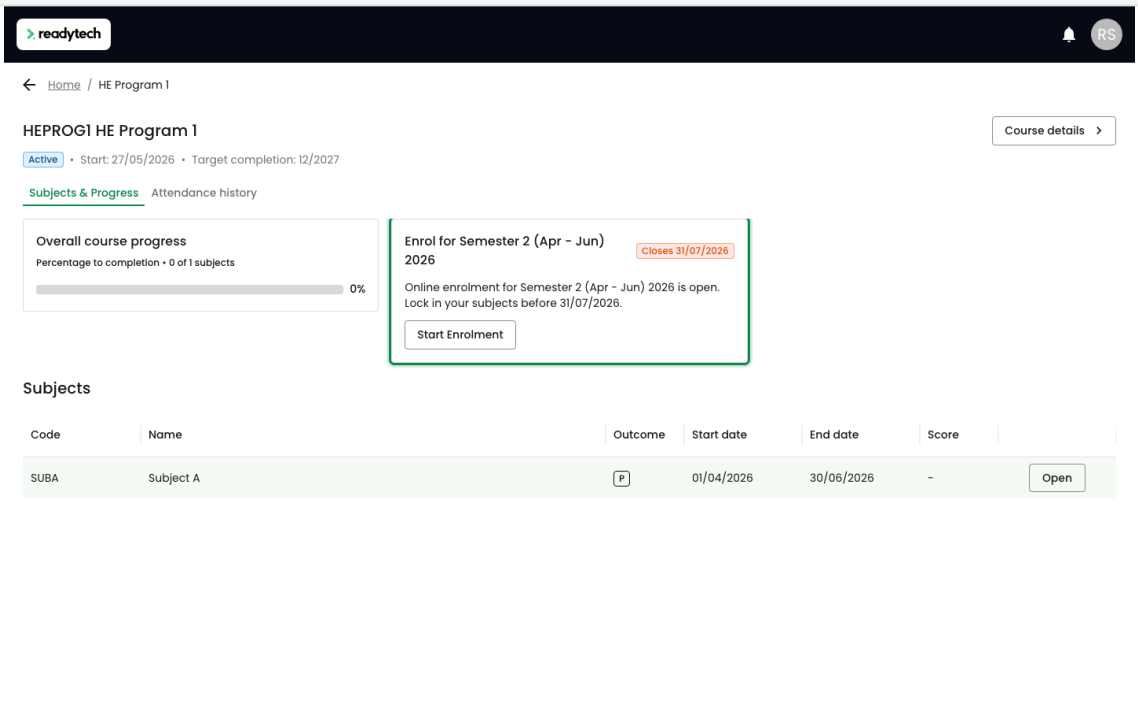
3 The journey begins on the portal

The student signs in to the Student Portal. When an enrolment window is open, the portal tells them — front and centre on their course page, with the closing date — so nobody misses their window.

Login → Dashboard → "Enrolment is open" banner → Start Enrolment



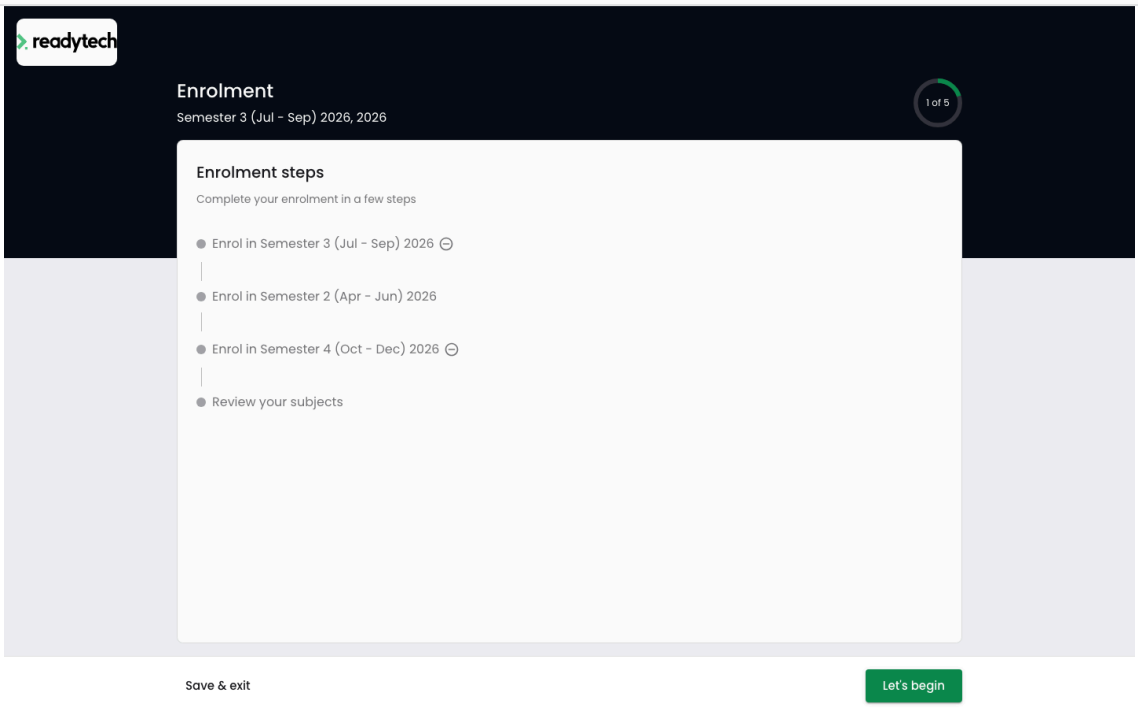
The student can't miss it. The moment the window opens, the dashboard flags it twice — an *Enrolment Open* badge on their study card, and an "Enrol for Semester 2 — closes 31 Jul 2026" task in the Action Centre with a one-click *Start*.



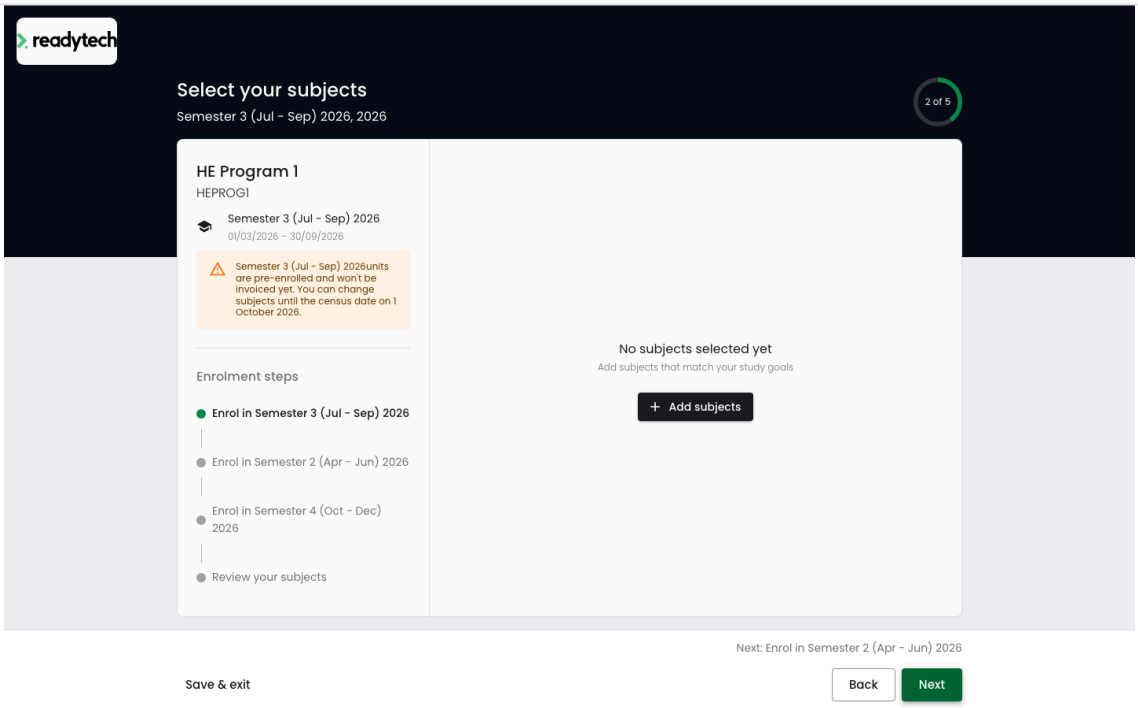
Course page with the enrolment invitation. "Online enrolment for Semester 2 is open. Lock in your subjects before 31/07/2026" — one click on *Start Enrolment* launches the wizard. The banner only appears while the institution's enrolment window is open.

4 A guided, step-by-step wizard

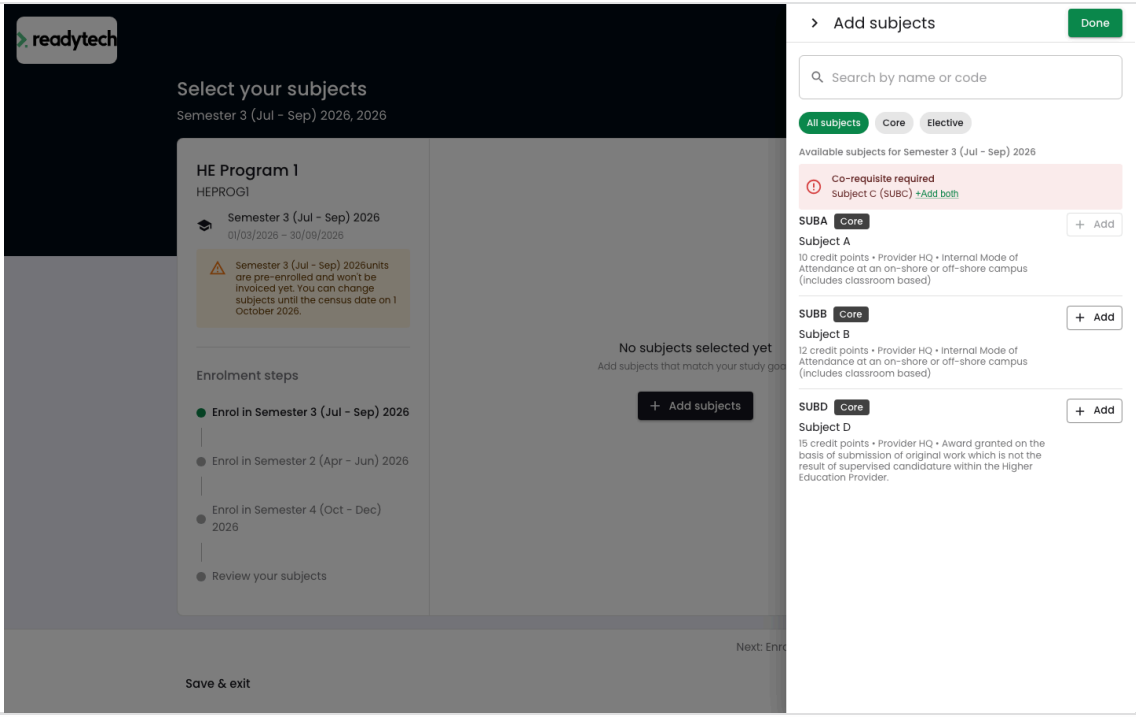
The wizard lays the whole process out before anything starts: one step per study period, then a final review. The student always knows where they are and what's left.



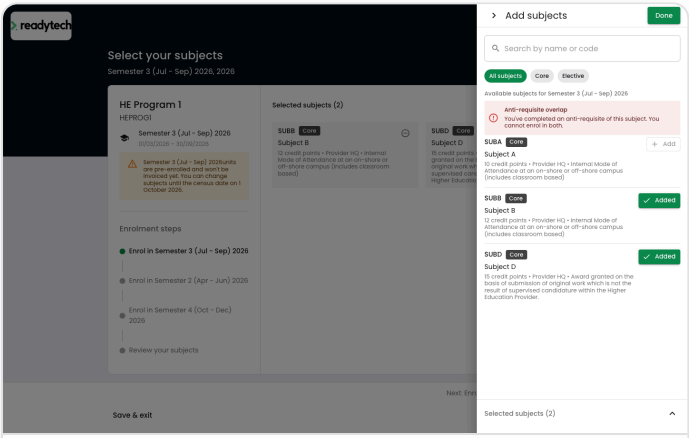
Enrolment steps. Every period in scope — here Semesters 2, 3 and 4 of 2026 — is a step, finishing with a review. Optional periods can be removed; the student's primary period cannot.



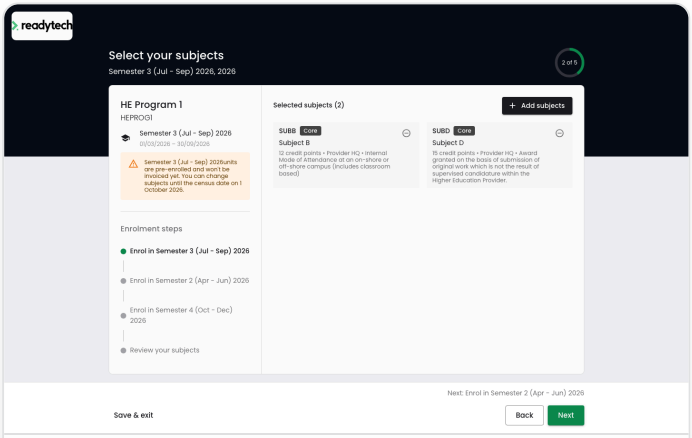
Selecting subjects for a period. The left rail keeps the program, period dates, key notices (like the census date) and progress visible throughout. The student starts with a clean slate and builds their selection.



The subject catalogue. Every offering available *to this student, in this period, in their program* — searchable by name or code and filterable by Core / Elective. Credit points, location and attendance mode are right on the card.



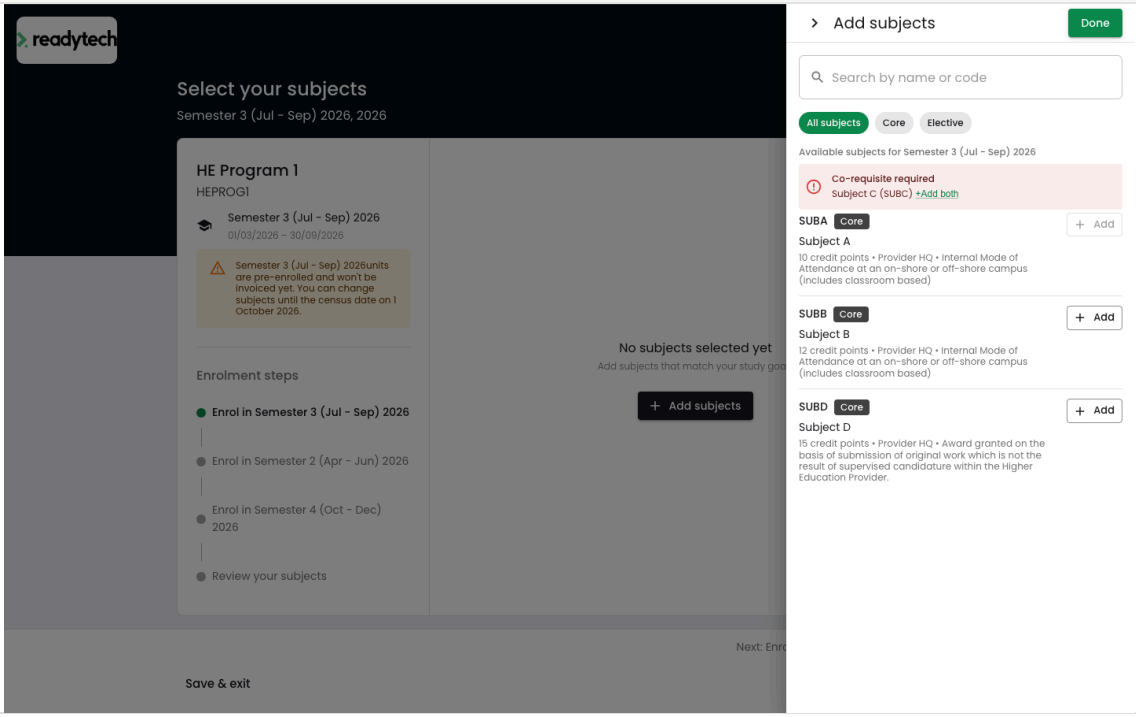
Adding is one tap. The running "Selected subjects" counter keeps score at the bottom of the drawer.



The period takes shape. Selected subjects appear as cards with their credit points — removable up until the student confirms.

5 Requisite Rules/Validations

This is the heart of the feature. The student is free to choose — but the platform enforces the institution's rules at every step, in real time. And unlike admin-led enrolment, **there is no override**.



Requisites, enforced live. Subject A requires Subject C as a co-requisite — so its Add button is disabled and the drawer explains exactly why, with a one-click "+ Add both" shortcut to resolve it. No invalid combination can ever be submitted.

Requisite rules

Pre- and co-requisites are evaluated as the student browses, and re-checked at confirmation. Failing combinations are blocked with a clear explanation.

Program structure

Only subjects that belong to the student's program are offered. Anything outside their curriculum simply never appears.

Study load visibility

Credit points are totalled against the standard load for the study period as the student selects, so they can see exactly how full their semester is.

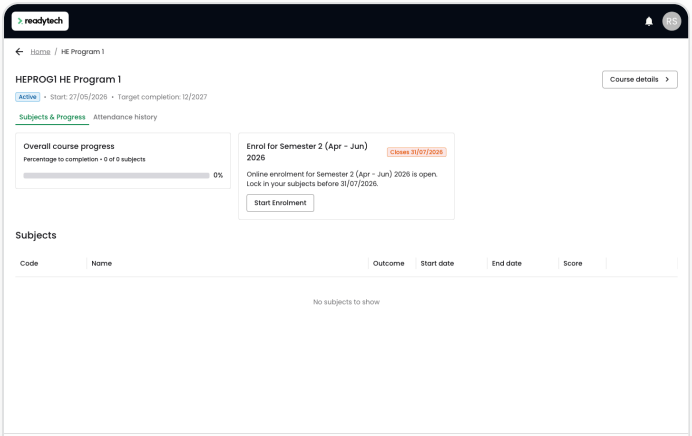
Enrolment windows

Open and close dates set per academic period control access completely — outside the window, the wizard is unreachable.

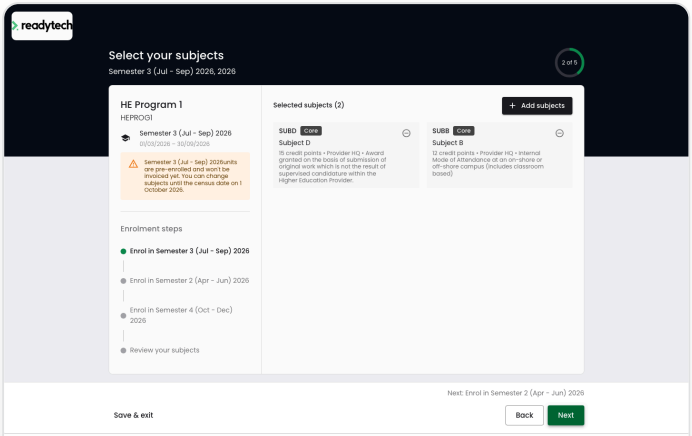
💡 **Worth calling out to clients:** validation is done by the same curriculum engine that powers admin-led enrolment — one source of truth for rules, whether staff or students drive the process.

6 Life happens — save & pick up later

Choosing subjects is a big decision. Students can save their progress at any point and come back — their selection is waiting exactly where they left it, on any device.



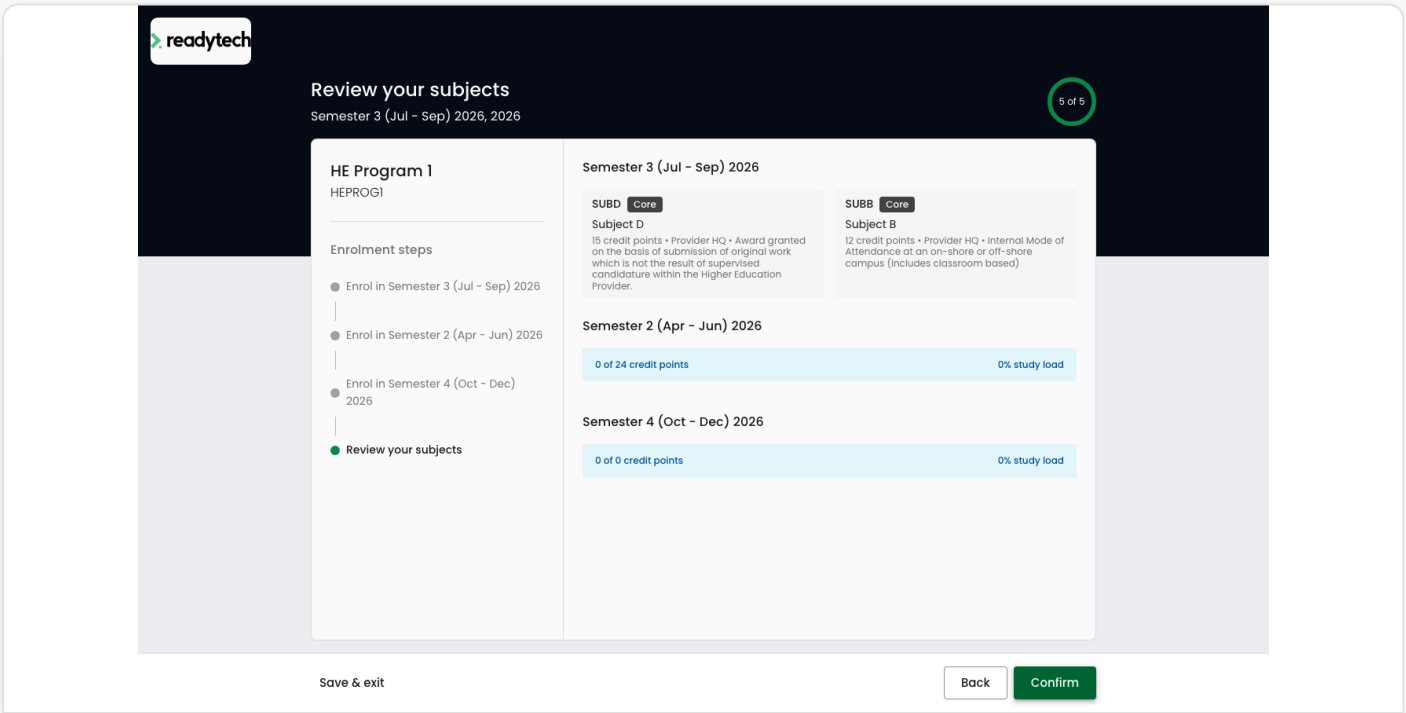
"Save & exit" returns the student safely to their course page — nothing submitted, nothing lost.



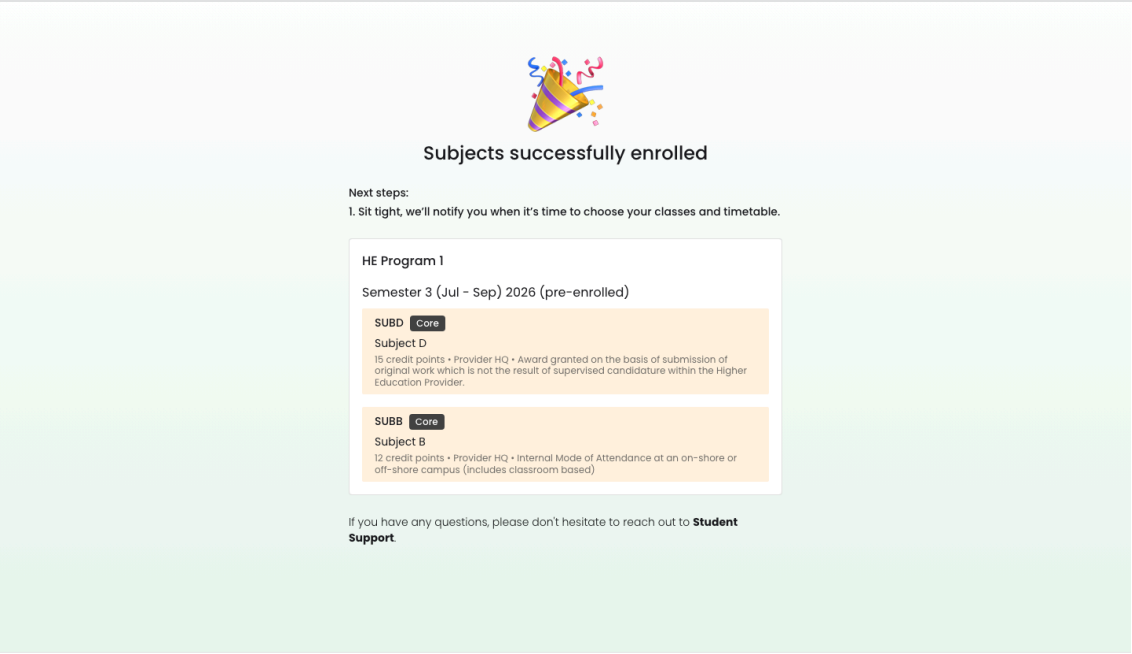
Back where they left off. Re-entering the wizard restores both previously selected subjects automatically.

7 Review, confirm — enrolled

Before anything is committed, the student sees a full summary of every period and every subject. One tap on *Confirm* runs the final validation pass and writes the enrolment into the student management system — instantly.



The review step. A read-only summary — requisites are re-verified here one final time before the Confirm button activates.



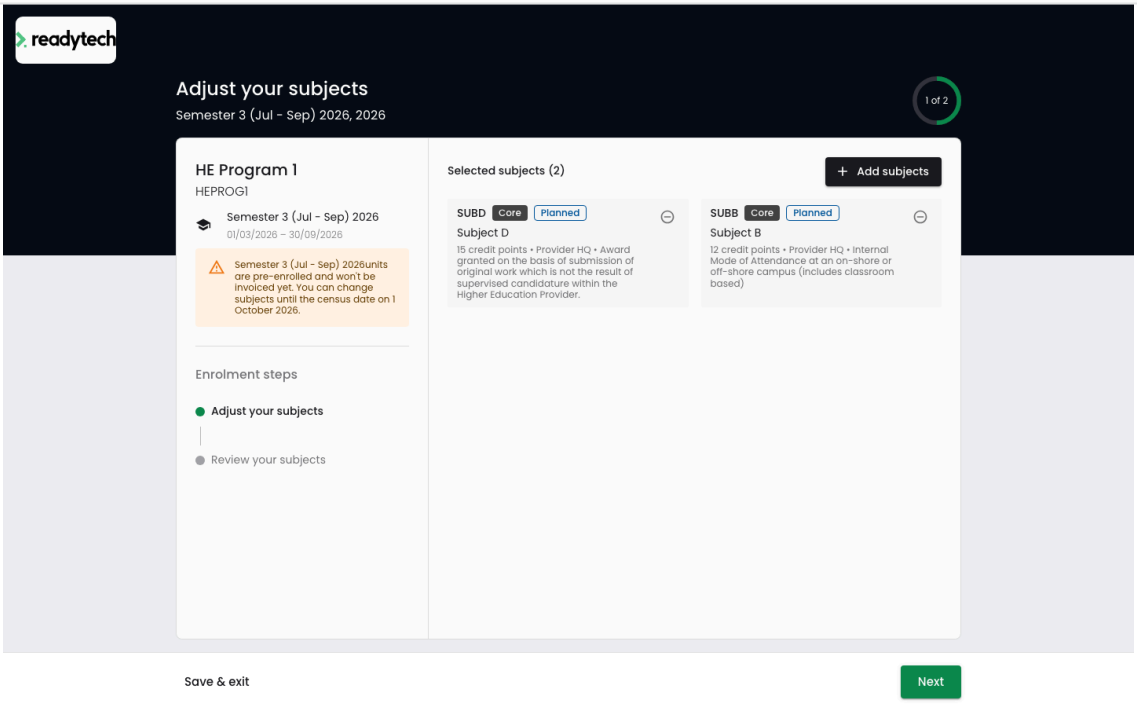
🎉 **Done.** Subjects are enrolled in the SMS in real time — with clear next steps for the student. Staff see the enrolment immediately in the SMS; nothing to re-key.

🔒 **Safe by design:** the confirmation is protected against double-submission, and if any rule fails at the last moment (e.g. a requisite), the whole submission rolls back — a student can never end up half-enrolled.

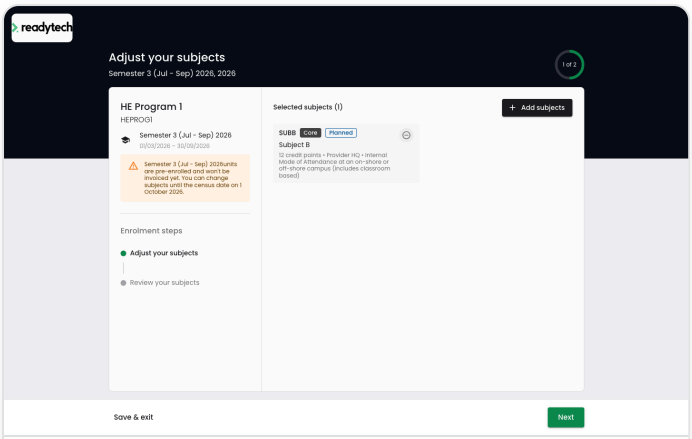
8 Changed your mind? Adjust within the window

Enrolment isn't a one-shot decision. Until the institution's deadline, students can return and adjust — dropping subjects or adding new ones — through the same familiar experience.

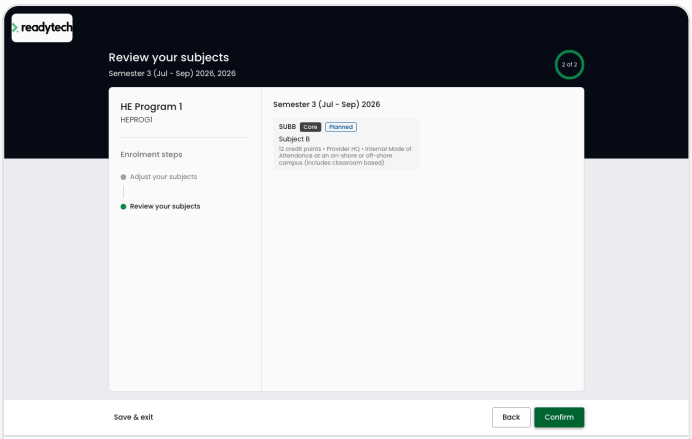
Adjust your subjects → Drop / add → Review → **Subjects adjusted**



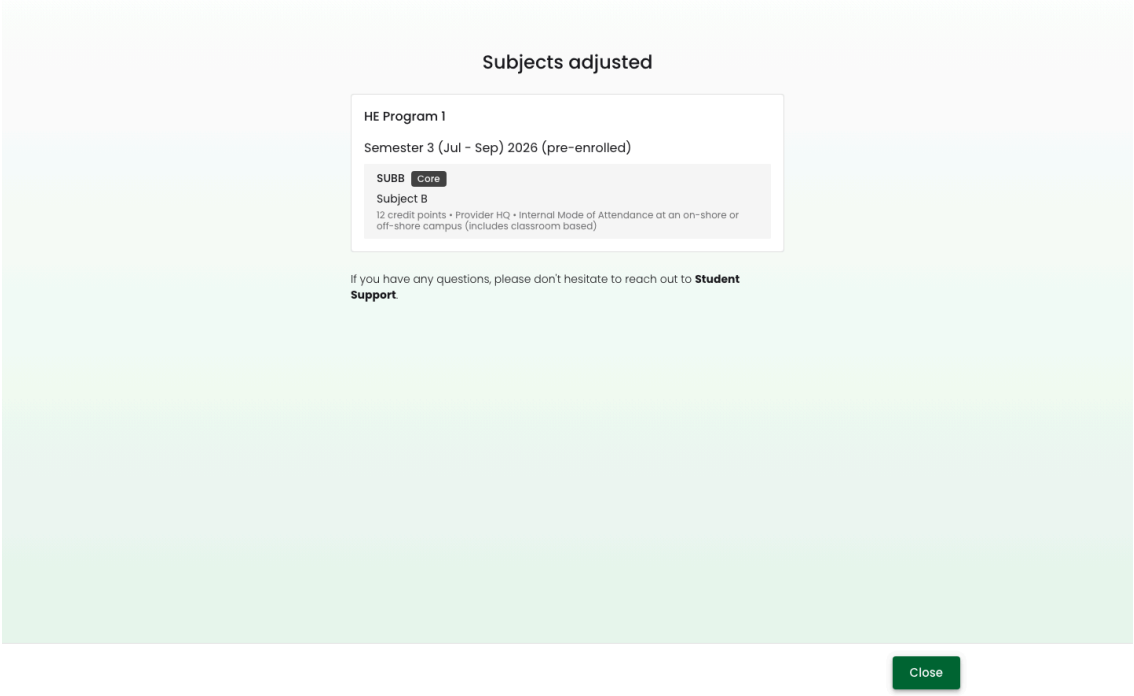
The adjust flow. The student's current subjects appear with a *Planned* status badge — each one removable while the adjustment window is open.



Dropping Subject D. One tap and the selection updates — the drop is only committed at confirmation.



A short two-step flow. Adjust → review → confirm. Quick for the student, fully validated for the institution.



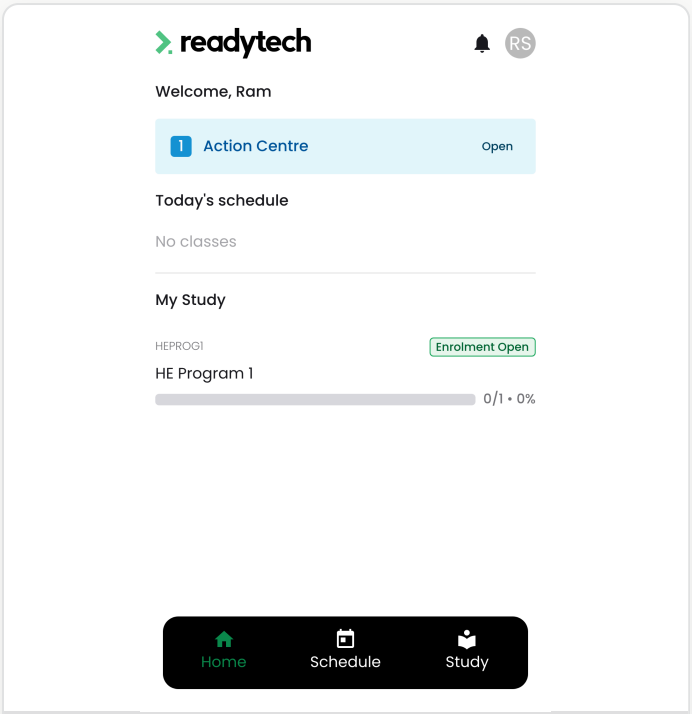
Adjusted. The withdrawal is processed with the correct outcome behind the scenes, and the student's updated subject list is confirmed on screen.

9 Built for every screen — mobile-first

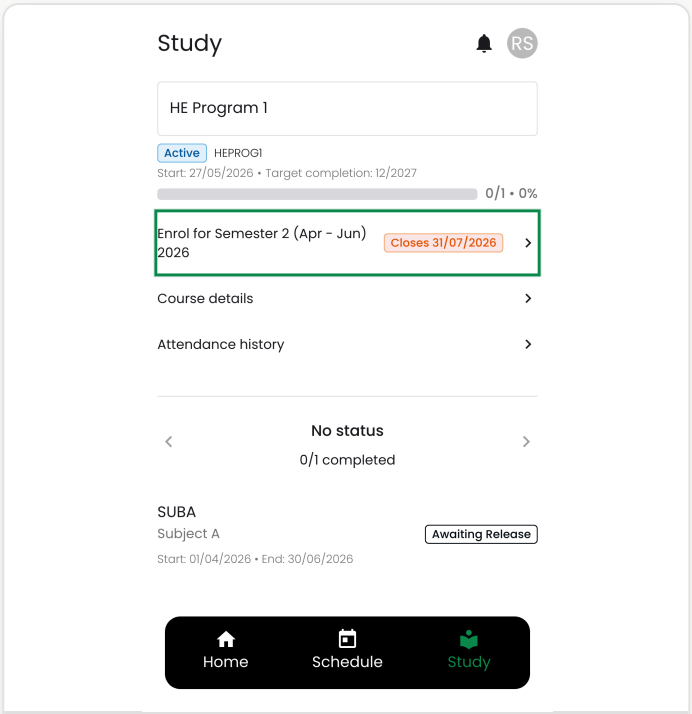
The entire self-enrolment experience is fully adaptive. Students on phones get a purpose-built mobile layout — not a squeezed desktop view — with the same guardrails, the same wizard, and the same instant confirmation.

> 📱 **Server-side adaptive design:** the portal detects the device on the server and delivers a mobile-optimised layout automatically — no pinch-to-zoom, no horizontal scrolling. Every screen shown below is the real mobile experience, not a responsive breakpoint.

Discovery & entry

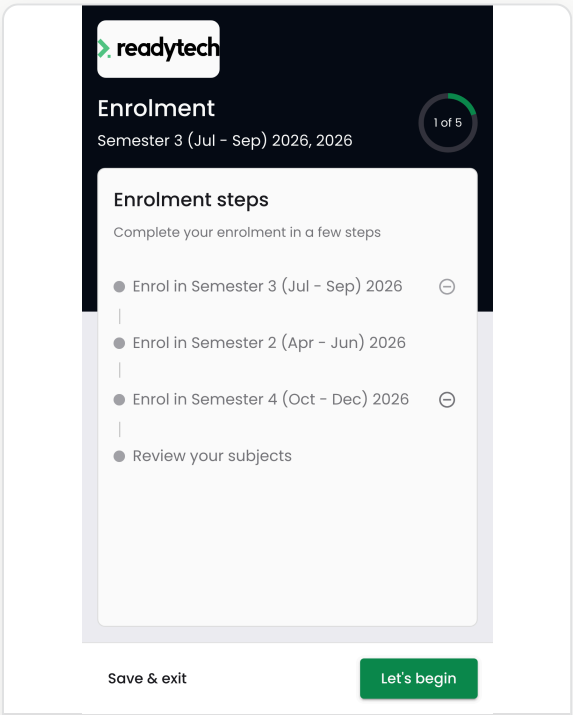


Mobile dashboard. The *Enrolment Open* badge is visible on the study card and the Action Centre is one tap away. The floating bottom navigation keeps Home, Schedule and Study within reach.



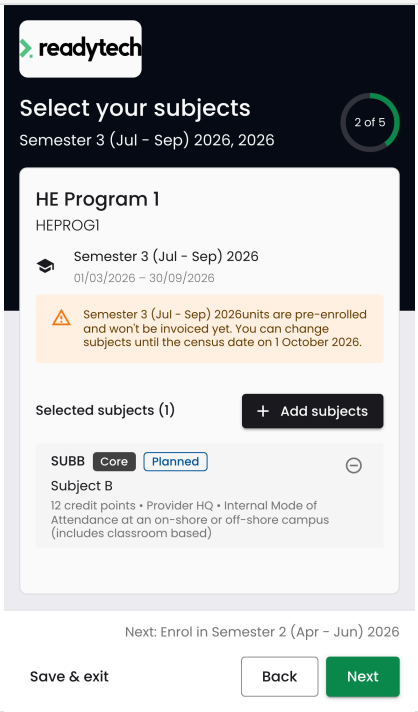
Study page with enrolment invitation. "Enrol for Semester 2 — Closes 31/07/2026" is a tappable card that launches the wizard. Subject status badges (*Awaiting Release*) are right on the card.

The wizard on mobile

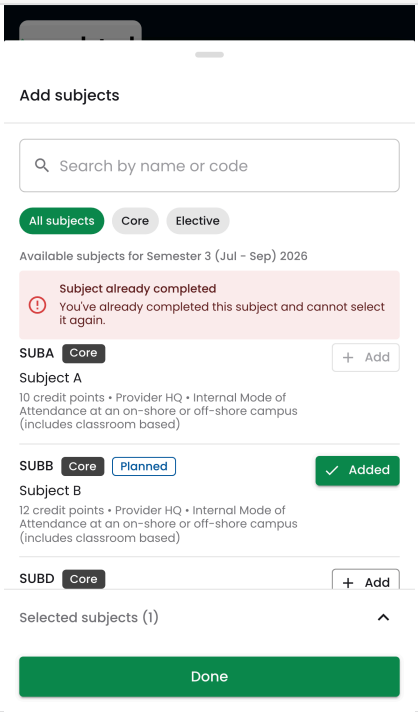


Enrolment steps. The same step-by-step stepper, with progress ring, "Save & exit" and "Let's begin" — all thumb-reachable at the bottom of the screen.

Selecting subjects



Select subjects on mobile. Program info, period dates, the census-date notice and selected subjects are stacked vertically. Credit points, location and attendance mode are all visible without scrolling sideways.



Add subjects — bottom drawer. The subject catalogue opens as a swipeable bottom sheet. Search, Core/Elective filters and the "Added" toggle all work identically to desktop. The "Selected subjects" counter and Done button anchor at the bottom.

✅ **Same rules, same flow, different form factor.** Requisite validation, study-load tracking, save & resume, review and confirm — every guardrail that exists on desktop works identically on mobile. Students can start on their laptop and finish on their phone.

Summary

What the Dynamite Squad delivered, in one view.

Capability	What it means for the institution
Enrolment modes	Three flows from one wizard: **whole-year** (all periods in a calendar year), **single period** (one semester), and **adjust** (change an existing enrolment). Institutions choose the pattern that matches their intake model.
Guided subject selection	Search, Core/Elective filtering, credit points, location and attendance mode per offering — scoped automatically to the student's program and period.
Real-time guardrails	Requisite evaluation, program-structure validation and study-load visibility while the student selects — with no student override possible.
Enrolment windows	Open, close and drop deadlines configured per academic period in the SMS gate all access, down to the day.
Save & resume	Progress persists across sessions and devices until the student is ready to commit.
Add & drop	Students adjust their own enrolments within the allowed window; withdrawals are recorded with the correct outcome automatically.
Instant SMS integration	Confirmed selections write straight into the SMS — staff see them immediately, with zero re-keying.

Capability	What it means for the institution
Mobile-ready	A fully adaptive mobile experience — server-side device detection delivers a purpose-built layout, not a responsive compromise. Students can enrol from any device.
Controlled rollout	The entire capability is switched per provider — institutions opt in when they're ready.

🚀 **The takeaway:** students get a modern, consumer-grade enrolment experience; institutions keep complete control of the rules; and staff get their time back.